



△ Fokker Dr.I 1917

Origin Germany

Engine 110 hp Oberursel Ur.II air-cooled 9-cylinder rotary

Top speed 115 mph (185 km/h)

Famous as the favorite mount of Manfred von Richthofen (the Red Baron), the "Dreidecker" was Fokker's effective response to the highly maneuverable Sopwith Triplane; 320 were built.



△ Fokker D.VII 1918

Origin Germany

Engine 180 hp Mercedes-Benz D.IIIaü water-cooled 6-cylinder in-line

Top speed 118 mph (190 km/h)

The last of the Fokker fighters of WWI, the Reinhold Platz-designed D.VII was judged the best German fighter aircraft in early 1918. Its steel-tube fuselage and cantilever wings were ahead of their time.



◁ Albatros D.Va 1916

Origin Germany

Engine 180 hp Mercedes-Benz D.IIIa water-cooled 6-cylinder in-line

Top speed 116 mph (186 km/h)

The Albatros D-series (this is a late Va) won back air domination for Germany in 1917. With light, strong semimonocoque plywood fuselage, it was fast and had good firepower, but was not very maneuverable.



△ Royal Aircraft Factory S.E.5a 1916

Origin UK

Engine 200 hp Hispano-Suiza/Wolseley Viper water-cooled V8

Top speed 138 mph (222 km/h)

Once shortage of its French-built engine was overcome by Wolseley building them, the stable, fast, and strong S.E.5a helped the Allies regain air superiority in mid-1917 and keep it to the end of the war.



△ SPAD SVII 1916

Origin France

Engine 220 hp Hispano-Suiza water-cooled V8

Top speed 135 mph (218 km/h)

Designed by Louis Béchereau, and armed with one gun, this was one of the most capable fighters of WWI. Strength and speed from its powerful V8 engine made up for its limited agility.

▽ Junkers D.I 1918

Origin Germany

Engine 185 hp BMW IIIa water-cooled 6-cylinder inline

Top speed 109 mph (176 km/h)

Arriving too late to have any impact on the war, the D.I was significant in that its low wing and all-metal airframe pointed the way forward for fighters and commercial aircraft alike.

